



Roles of Community and Social Development Project (CSDP) on the Livelihoods of Rural Farmers in Katsina State, Nigeria

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ABSTRACT

Key words:

Community and social development, livelihood, roles, rural farmers

The study assessed roles of community and social development project (CSDP) on the livelihood of rural farmers in Katsina State, Nigeria. A multistage sampling technique was used to select 150 CSDP farmers. Data collected were analyzed using frequencies, percentages, mean and t-test. The results revealed that majority (90.0%) of the respondents were males, married (90.7%) and mostly (36.7%) had primary education. Average age and household size were 48 years and 7 members respectively, with a mean farming experience of 22 years and average farm size of 2 hectares. The study examined effectiveness of CSDP approach in terms of proper funding of the project by the beneficiaries ($m=4.15$) and taking into consideration of vulnerable people ($m=4.01$) which ranked 1st and 2nd respectively. Provision of water/borehole (97.3%) and Schools (82.6%) by CSDP were found highly beneficial.. The results also shows average annual income of the respondents increased by N85, 990.8 and with significant difference at $P<0.1$ after CSDP intervention. The result further revealed that public awareness on different environmental management practices ($m= 4.75$), proper waste disposal ($m=4.71$) and reduction of deforestation in the communities ($m=4.67$) were found to enhanced environmental management practices and ranked 1st, 2nd and 3rd respectively. The respondents identified conflicts in project identification ($m=3.93$), poor need assessment ($m=3.79$) and poor utilization of funds by beneficiaries (3.75%) as the major challenges inhibiting respondent's involvement in the project. The study concluded that CSDP project had impacted positively on the lives of the beneficiaries. The study recommends that inclusive planning and implementation of projects.

INTRODUCTION

One of the major indices of social change is indeed rural development. Rural areas remain a dominant landscape in most areas, given that the general populace heavily depends on the areas for food and economic development (International Fund for Agricultural Development [IFAD], 2021). Improved productivity and quality of life of rural dwellers, depends on the social supports available to them in persons and/or to their environment (Majnouni-Toutakhane and Khaleghi, 2021). Development of the rural areas calls for the provision of basic infrastructure and social amenities with a view to improving the quality of life of rural dwellers. Udu and Onwe (2016) opined that over 80% of the population of developing countries resides in the rural community. According to Oyesola (2013), almost 80% of the population in Nigeria live in rural areas and are directly or indirectly involved in the use of land resources with majority of them facing several challenges which include environmental constraints, lack of infrastructural facilities, marketing problems and technological constraints, institutional challenges, high cost of labour, inadequate

agricultural incentive and lack of sustainable rural development programmes. As a result, the Federal Government of Nigeria and the World Bank were unanimous on the desirability of the Community Driven Development Approach (CDD). Due to this conviction, the World Bank, agreed to partner with the Federal Government to prepare and support two pilot projects, the Local Empowerment and Environmental Management Project (LEEMP) in nine (9) States of Nigeria, and the Community Based Poverty Reduction Project (CPRP) which was carried out in twelve (12) States of the country by providing resources in the form of a concessionary credit to implement these two pilot projects as a Poverty reduction Programme (CBN, 2004).

Katsina State, as one of the participating States, received a credit from the World Bank through the Federal Government for the LEEMP. The project's implementation in Katsina State, culminated in the execution of Three Hundred and Fifty-Four (354) micro-projects in Education, Health, Water, Physical Infrastructure, Socio-economic activities, Rural Electrification, Environment and natural Resources (Drainage, Woodlots and Reclamation Schemes) among others aimed at improving the quality of rural populace. Considering the tremendous success recorded under the LEEMP, CPRP and other related projects that adopted the CDD approaches, the Federal Government of Nigeria and the World Bank under the 2004-2009 Country Partnership Strategy (CPS) decide to harmonize World Bank funded CDD projects in the country. To this end the LEEMP and CRPP were merged into Community and Social Development Project (CSDP) with emphasis on provision of social and natural resources infrastructure service (CSDP, 2011). Empirical evidence shows that underdevelopment continued to wage on as people appear either ignorant of or indifferent to the reasons for which Local Governments are created. The major function of a Local Government is to meet the peculiar needs of the people at the grass root.

However, majority of the projects and services embarked upon by successive governments (Federal, State and Local) in Nigeria yielded little of the desired result partly because of the top-down, supply-driven and non-participatory mode of delivering services to communities (Edoh, 2011). It is against this background this study was conducted to achieve the following objectives: describe the socio-economic characteristics of the rural farmers in the study area; examine the effectiveness of community development approach use by CSDPs; assess the benefits derived from CADP project; determined the impact of CSDP on the income of respondents; ascertain the extent at which CSDP project enhance environmental management in the participating communities, and describe the constraints faced by the respondents as a result of their involvement in CSDP. The study tested null hypothesis; H_0 : There is no significance difference on the income of rural farmers before and after the CSDP project in the study area.

MATERIALS AND METHOD

Study Area

This study was conducted in Katsina State, which is located in the North Western part of Nigeria. It is situated in the Sudan Savannah agro-ecological zone of Nigeria and lies between latitude 12.5139°N , and longitude 7.6114°E . It has a total land area of about $23,986\text{km}^2$ and estimated population of about 5,59,2256 based on the 2006 census (NPC, 2006). Using the annual growth rate of 0.0305% as reported by GEMS, (2013) the population of the State in 2019 was projected at 8,568,898. The State has annual rainfall of between 640mm in the extreme North to 1056mm towards the Southern part, and the rainfall occurs with district wet and dry season. A predominantly agrarian State, with an estimated 80% of the population residing in the rural areas and 20% resides in urban and

semi-urban areas. Major rain fed crops are sorghum, millet, maize and rice and major cash crops includes cotton, groundnut, cowpea, soybean, sesame and peppers.

The state lies on a major water divide between Niger North in the West, Lake Chad in the East and Niger Central to the South. The river system to the West drains into River Rima (Sani, 2009).

Sampling Procedure

A multi-stage sampling technique was used for selecting respondents for the study. The first stage involved purposive selection of three (3) Local Government Areas (Dutsin-ma, Rimi and Katsina) and two (2) communities each from the selected LGAs due to high number of micro-projects executed in those LGAs and the communities respectively. The communities are; Shema Gari and Kofa from Dutsin-ma LGA Kutare and Alaraini from Rimi LGA, Bayajidda and Abbatuwa from Katsina LGA. Finally, a total of 150 farmers were selected randomly from the sample frame of 752 based on proportionate selection of 20% of farmers population from each community.

Method of Data Collection

Structured questionnaire was the instrument used to collect the primary data for the study, which was meant for achieving the objectives of the study.

The questionnaire was administered by the researcher with the help of trained enumerators. Also, Five Likert-type scale (1=strongly disagreed, 2=disagreed, 3=undecided, 4=agreed and 5=strongly agreed) was used to score responses from statements provided on the effectiveness of CSDP project approach, extent of CSDP enhancement of environmental management and constraints faced by respondents in the implementation of the project.

Analytical Techniques

Descriptive statistics (mean, percentage, and frequency count) and T-test were used for the study. Independent T-test with equal sample size was used to test the null hypothesis. The general formula of the t-test is given as:

t =

$$t = \frac{\bar{x}_1 - \bar{x}_2}{\sqrt{\frac{s_1^2 + s_2^2}{n_1 + n_2}}}$$

.....

(1)

Where:

t= t-value

$\bar{X}_1$ = the mean sample of respondents' income in benefiting communities before initiating the CSDP

$\bar{X}_2$ = the mean sample of respondents' income in benefiting communities after initiating the CSDP.

S_1^2 = sample standard deviation for respondent's income in benefiting communities before initiating the program

S_2^2 = sample standard deviation for respondent's income in benefiting communities after initiating the program

n_1 = sample size of respondents' income in benefiting communities before the programme

n_2 = sample size of respondents' income in benefiting communities after initiating the program

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

Socio-economic Characteristics of the Respondents

The result in table 1 shows that average age of the respondents was 48 years implying that respondents were young and energetic and can participate in CSDP project. This is in contrast with the findings of Sidi *et al.*, (2020) who reported 29.7 years occupying a class interval between 39-48 years.

The average household size of the respondents in table 1 was 7 persons per household. This implies that majority of the respondents had above the National average of 4.7 persons per household as reported by National Population Commission [NPC] and International Classification of Functioning, Disability and Health [ICF] (2019). Respondents had dependents to cater for and their participation in projects like CSDP could help in engaging them on the farm and improving their livelihoods. The finding is in agreement with Abbas (2017) who reported an average household size of 9 and 8 members among beneficiaries and non-beneficiaries in his study area.

Years of farming experience in Table 1 indicated 22 years on average. This shows that the respondents had considerable years of experience in farming and could help in effective resource allocation in their farming enterprise and also contribute toward adoption of improved technologies. Sani (2019) found similar result in his work that farmers in Katsina State had 23 years of farming experience. Moreover, average farm size of the respondents was 2 hectares.

The mean annual income of the respondents before and after the CSDP project was ₦155,613 and ₦241,603.4 respectively. The result shows that average income increased to ₦85,990.4 after participating in CSDP project. The result further revealed that there was 64.5% increase in household annual income after the CSDP project. The change in annual income indicated that CSDP project has succeeded in achieving its household income goal within its period of operation, and subsequently improved well-being among the rural farmers. This agreed with the findings of Abbas (2017), who reported a mean annual farm income of ₦191,666.67 among bank of agriculture loan beneficiaries in Katsina State.

Table 1: Socio-Economic Characteristics of the Respondents (n = 150)

Variables	Minimum	Maximum	Mean
Age (years)	25	71	48
Household size (number)	1	22	7
Farming experience (years)	3	50	22
Farm Size (Ha)	0.5	5	2
Annual Income (₦)			
Before	43,500	105,700	155.613
After	67,300	223,500	241,603.8

Source: Field Survey, 2022.

The result of socio-economic characteristics in table 2 further revealed that males were the dominant sex (90%). This implied that access and control of agricultural resources remain largely in the hands of males. This could be attributed to most African traditions which prevent women from interacting freely with men as the case in this study area. This agreed with findings of Sidi *et al.* (2020) who reported similar findings about the farmers in their study area were males.

Almost all (90.7%) the respondents were married; only 5.3% were singles. This implies that married respondents were targeted by CADP and this could be due to the enormous responsibilities associated with married respondents towards provision of basic needs of their family members. Most (86%) of the respondents had formal education; this high literacy level could probably enable the respondents harness the benefits associated with CSDP project. Seventy-eight percent of the respondents indicated association membership.

The membership of association may likely have a positive impact on the wellbeing of smallholder farmers.

Table 2: Socio-Economic Characteristics of the Respondents [Continuation]
(n=150)

Variable	Frequency	Percentage
Sex		
Male	135	90.0
Female	15	10.0
Marital Status		
Single	8	5.3
Married	136	90.7
Divorced	3	2.0
Widowed/Widower	3	2.0
Educational Status		
Non-formal Education	21	14.0
Primary	55	36.7
Secondary	43	28.7
Tertiary	17	11.3
Vocational	14	9.3
Membership of Association		
Member	117	78.0
Non-member	33	22.0
Benefit of Membership		
Agricultural production	19	12.7
Access to credit/loan	46	30.7
Access to agricultural inputs	33	22.0
Social belonging	27	18
Group dynamics training	25	16.6

Source: Field Survey, 2022

Effectiveness of Community and Social Development Project (CSDP) Approach

The results in Table 3 revealed that the approach ensures proper funding of the project (m=4.15), taking into consideration vulnerable people (m=4.01) and encourages community participation (m=3.99) as the most effective approach used by CSDP which ranked 1st, 2nd and 3rd respectively. It was reported by Adi *et al.* (2022) that delay in payment of counterpart funds from government and the communities as one of the major problems militating against CSDP in their study area.

Table 3: effectiveness of Community and Social Development Project on Respondents
(n=150)

Effectiveness of CSDP Approach	Mean	Ranking
Proper funding of the project by the stakeholders	4.15	1 st
The approach takes into consideration vulnerable people	4.01	2 nd
Approach encourages community participation in project development	3.99	3 rd
Proper implementation of the project	3.95	4 th
Sustainability of the project after completion	3.85	5 th
Full support in community mobilization	3.79	6 th
Projects addresses the felt needs of the communities	3.61	7 th

Partnership exist among other institutions including NGOs with a view of promoting community development	3.37	8 th
Implementation plan outlines the short/medium term targets of the communities	3.17	9 th

Source: Field Survey, 2022

Benefits Derived by Respondents from CSDP

Table 4 shows that provision of water/borehole was highly beneficial to almost all (97.3%) the respondents and ranked 1st among the infrastructure provided by CSDP in the study area. Schools provided was beneficial to most (82.6%) respondents and ranked 2nd among the infrastructure provided. This could improve the level of literacy in the area of study and subsequent economic development. Furthermore, provision of health centres was beneficial to majority (68.0%) of respondents which ranked 3rd. Thus, the infrastructure in question may bring about development to the area which may transform the lives of the residents as well as improve their livelihood. This is in line with Jonathan, (2014) who found out that micro projects of CSDP intervention impact significantly on community and social development of the rural dwellers as evident in the areas of health care, water supply, and wealth and job creation among youth. This is also in agreement with Joseph and Tordue (2013), who reported provision of water received topmost priority compare to other sectors of the micro projects executed by the CSDP during the first phase of implementation.

Table 4: Benefits Derived by the Respondents from CSDP

Source: Survey Data, 2022		* Multiple Responses	
Infrastructure	Frequency	Percentage	Ranking
Water/Borehole	146	97.3	1 st
Schools	124	82.6	2 nd
Health Centre	102	68.0	3 rd
Roads	26	17.3	4 th
Electricity	21	14.0	5 th
Market shade	17	11.3	6 th
Vocational Centre	11	7.3	7 th
Latrine	6	4.0	8 th

Estimated Impact of CSDP on the Income of Respondents

To estimate the impact of CSDP on the respondents mean annual income before and after the project, T-test was used to evaluate impact. The result as presented in Table 5 revealed t-statistics of 1.98 which shows a significant difference before and after the introduction of CSDP project at $P < 0.1$. Therefore, based on the result the null hypothesis that there is no significance difference on the income of rural farmers before and after the CSDP project is rejected in favour of the alternative hypothesis that there is significance difference on the income of rural farmers before and after the CSDP project in the study area.

Table 5: Estimated Impact of CSDP on the Income of Respondents

Variable	Average income of respondents before the CSDP project	Average income of respondents after the CSDP project	T-test
Mean annual income	₦155,613	₦241,603.8	1.98*

Source: Field Survey, 2022

*significant at $P < 0.1$

Extent at which CSDP Enhanced Environmental Management in the Communities

The result in Table 6, reveals that public awareness on different environmental management practices ranked 1st with a mean score of 4.75. CSDP help in proper waste disposal ($m=4.71$) and help in reducing deforestation in communities ($m=4.67$) ranked 2nd and 3rd respectively. The least ranked environmental management practice was establishment of woodlots and wind breaks as represented by a mean score of 4.06. This implies that, CSDP project helps in addressing environmental challenges and addresses most of the bedeviling factors in ensuring good and healthy living environment. This is in line with the findings by Ojo and Ehinmowo (2010) who found out that most of the environmental challenges to be addressed needs to include the people living in the affected area.

Table 6. Perceived Extent of CSDP Enhanced Environmental Management in the Communities

Variables	SA (5)	A (4)	U (3)	D (2)	SD (1)	Score	WMS	Rank
CSDP project help in reducing deforestation in the beneficiary communities	111(74.0)	28(18.7)	11(7.3)	0(0.0)	0(0.0)	700	4.67	3 rd
Construction of drainages to check flooding	26(17.3)	111(74.0)	13(8.7)	0(0.0)	0(0.0)	613	4.09	5 th
CSDP project help in proper waste disposal	116(77.3)	24(16.0)	10(6.7)	0(0.0)	0(0.0)	706	4.71	2 nd
Establishment of woodlots and wind breaks	21(14.0)	120(80.0)	7(4.7)	1(0.7)	1(0.7)	609	4.06	6 th
Encourages use of alternative source of fuel	107(71.3)	32(21.3)	11(7.3)	0(0.0)	0(0.0)	696	4.64	4 th
Public awareness on different environmental management practices	123(82.6)	19(12.7)	6(4.0)	2(1.4)	0(0.0)	713	4.75	1 st

Source: Field Survey, 2019 Note: SA= Strongly Agree, A =Agree, U = Undecided, D = Disagree, S= Strongly Disagree, WMS = Weighted Mean Score Note: Values in Parentheses are Percentage

Constraints Associated with Respondents Involvement in CSDP

Table 7 revealed that majority of the respondents considered conflict in project identification as the most important challenge facing the farmers ($m=3.93$) which was ranked 1st. Poor need assessment ($m=3.79$) and poor utilization of funds by beneficiaries ($m=3.75$) were ranked 2nd and 3rd constraints respectively. The result is in consonance with the findings of Sidi *et al.* (2020) who reported problem of payment of counterpart funds among CSDP beneficiaries in North West Nigeria.

Table 7: Perceived Constraints Faced by the Respondents during the Implementation of CSDP

Constraint	Mean	Ranking
Conflict in project identification	3.93	1 st
Poor need assessment	3.79	2 nd
Poor utilization of funds by beneficiaries	3.75	3 rd
Political interference and conflicts among beneficiaries	3.69	4 th
Problem of cost sharing between communities and government	3.35	5 th
Inadequate motivation and team work by the beneficiaries	3.32	6 th

Problem in sourcing fund among community members	3.29	7 th
Inadequate funding of the project	3.09	8 th

Source: Field Survey, 2019

Conclusion and Recommendations

The study concluded that CSDP project had impacted positively on the lives of the beneficiaries in Katsina State, Nigeria. It was also established that the approach was very effective in addressing the felt needs of the farmers, encourages community participation in project development, taking into cognizance vulnerable people and sustainability of the project after completion. The study therefore made the following recommendations:

- i. It was found out that CSDP had played a positive role on the livelihood of the respondents, therefore the project should be replicated in other non-CSDP benefiting Local Government Areas of the state in order to record a livelihood improvement.
- ii. Conflicts in project identification is one of the major constraints to participation in the project; beneficiaries should be encouraged to unanimously agree on particular project which will bring more positive development to the community.
- iii. Proper means of utilizing funds accessed for the project should strictly adhered to ensure implementation and execution of the project
- iv. More women should be encouraged to participate in the project through sensitization campaigns.

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